

Start here.

Nine pages for an animal that is awake when you are not, lives two or three years rather than fifteen, and is kept well or badly almost entirely by numbers. The home measured properly, the week, the food and the hoard, the night, taming and the weekly look-over, the sitter's page, and a log with room for growing old.

1 WHAT IS IN YOUR DOWNLOAD

4 fillable kits	Letter + A4 · colour + ink-saving mono · 9 pages each
4 print kits	the same pages without form fields
Print page 2 first	the vet who sees exotics, before you need one
This guide	printing and filling in, on one page

2 TYPE ON IT

Open a file ending in **-fillable.pdf** in Adobe Acrobat Reader (free) or a tablet app and type. Tick the boxes with a click. **Save a copy per hamster** — pages 1 to 7 are about one animal, and hamsters are kept one to a cage anyway.

3 OR PRINT AND WRITE

The **-print.pdf** files are the same nine pages without fields. Two of them are meant to leave the folder: **page 2** goes on the fridge with the exotics vet filled in, and **page 8** gets left out for whoever is looking in while you are away.

4 PRINT IT WELL

- Paper: plain A4 or US Letter, 90–120 gsm
- Scale: **100% / Actual size** — never “Fit to page”
- Page 3 is worth printing twice: once now, once after you have measured
- Saving ink? The **mono** kit is the same layout in graphite only

5 WHAT THIS IS, AND WHAT IT IS NOT

It is a **record book**, made by a designer. It is not veterinary advice, not a diagnosis, and not a substitute for phoning a vet. The figures on page 3 are the ones experienced hamster keepers work to rather than the minimum a box will quote you, and the signs on page 2 are a short list, not a complete one. Find a practice that sees small exotics **today**, while nothing is wrong: many do not, and a hamster that is unwell on a Friday evening does not have until Monday.